Ian Douglas

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Dear Hiring Team,

I build cloud and platform infrastructure the way I'd build any production software: as versioned releases, secured by design, and operated through automation. Over 12 years across AWS, Azure, GCP, and bare metal, with Kubernetes at the core, I have designed the architecture, written the code, and run the platform in production. That combination is what I'd bring to your team.

Platform as a product, at scale. At Pearson I built and operated Bitesize, a self-managed Kubernetes platform on AWS serving 400 development teams and proven under 8.5 million concurrent users at sub-250 ms. We delivered the platform continuously as 14 independently versioned components, promoted by 121 GitHub Actions jobs through eight clusters to two production regions, gated by tests, human approvals, and automated ServiceNow changes. Releases went from one or two a year to several a day (case study).

Kubernetes on Azure. At ZagTech I engineered a commercial Kubernetes platform on Azure (AKS), deployed across multiple enterprise clients. The codebase was a primary value driver in the firm's subsequent acquisition. I designed the Flux GitOps hierarchy for those fleets and created a composable Terraform design for ordering complex clusters from a menu (Kate's Kitchen).

Identity and security by design. At Stanford I containerized the university's primary identity store, OpenLDAP, as a Kubernetes service with master/replica StatefulSets and lifecycle automation. It underpinned identity and access for all of Stanford. I also authored the reference implementation for a cloud-resident Active Directory: an isolated domain where clients must establish certificate-authenticated IPsec before they can reach it. Today I co-run a consultancy building Terraform-based Zero Trust capability packages modeled on NIST SP 800-207.

Automation that compounds. I use agentic tools such as Claude Code to ship production automation quickly. At The Motley Fool I built Python tooling that migrated about 200 repositories from Jenkins to GitHub Actions, including moving secrets from AWS Secrets Manager to dotenvx.

I'd welcome the chance to discuss how I can help your team build and run its platform. I'm happy to walk through any of this in more depth.

Sincerely,

Ian Douglas